

AI governance among AI-using businesses

PRIVATE CANDIDATE - OWNER REVIEW

The third insight adds governance to the adoption and integration story. It asks whether businesses already using AI have any formal or informal policy or guidance for its use or development.

Key finding

Among AI-using businesses, 20.1% of micro, 29.0% of small and 36.8% of medium businesses reported a formal or informal AI policy or guidance. The large-business reference benchmark was 67.7%.

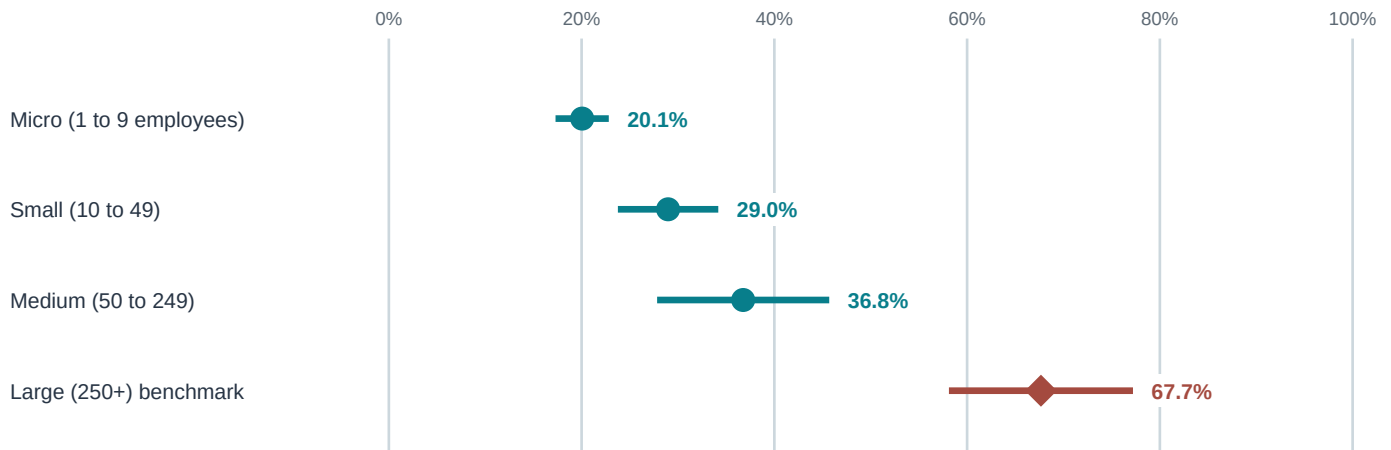
ADOPTION All businesses Breadth of reported AI use	INTEGRATION AI-using businesses Connection to business systems	GOVERNANCE AI-using businesses Policy or guidance in place
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How to read this

This is a conditional measure. It says nothing about businesses that do not report using AI. The point estimates are descriptive and do not prove that size causes governance differences.

Policy or guidance among AI users

Percentage of UK businesses in each published size group that use AI technologies and report any formal or informal AI policy or guidance.



Evidence table

Published size	Estimate	95% interval	Base
Micro (1 to 9 employees)	20.1%	17.3% to 22.8%	960
Small (10 to 49)	29.0%	23.8% to 34.2%	350
Medium (50 to 249)	36.8%	27.8% to 45.7%	130
Large (250+) benchmark	67.7%	58.1% to 77.2%	100

Interpretation

The point estimates rise across the published size groups. Within the primary SME groups, the estimate is lowest for micro businesses and highest for medium businesses. The large-business benchmark is higher than the three SME estimates. No pairwise significance test is claimed.

What this insight supports

A practical message

AI use does not automatically mean formal governance is in place. For SME support, policy templates and clear guidance may be useful alongside tools and technical integration.

What the evidence does not establish

The survey does not show that business size causes policy adoption. Rounded unweighted bases are respondent counts, not numbers of UK businesses. The confidence intervals are retained, but no new pairwise significance test has been performed.

Why the denominator matters

These percentages apply only to businesses that report using AI technologies. They must not be described as the share of all UK businesses with an AI policy and must not be multiplied by the adoption percentages without a separately approved method.

Evidence trail

Department for Science, Innovation and Technology, UK Business Data Survey 2026, Table 50. Fieldwork ran from 10 October 2025 to 28 January 2026. Central estimates, supplied 95% confidence limits and rounded unweighted bases are preserved.

Review boundary: candidate F-003 remains private until the consolidated three-report and website review is accepted.